US 281

SAN ANTONIO TO I-20

FACT SHEET

STATEWIDE AND RURAL CONNECTIVITY
Key Corridors
TPP DIVISION

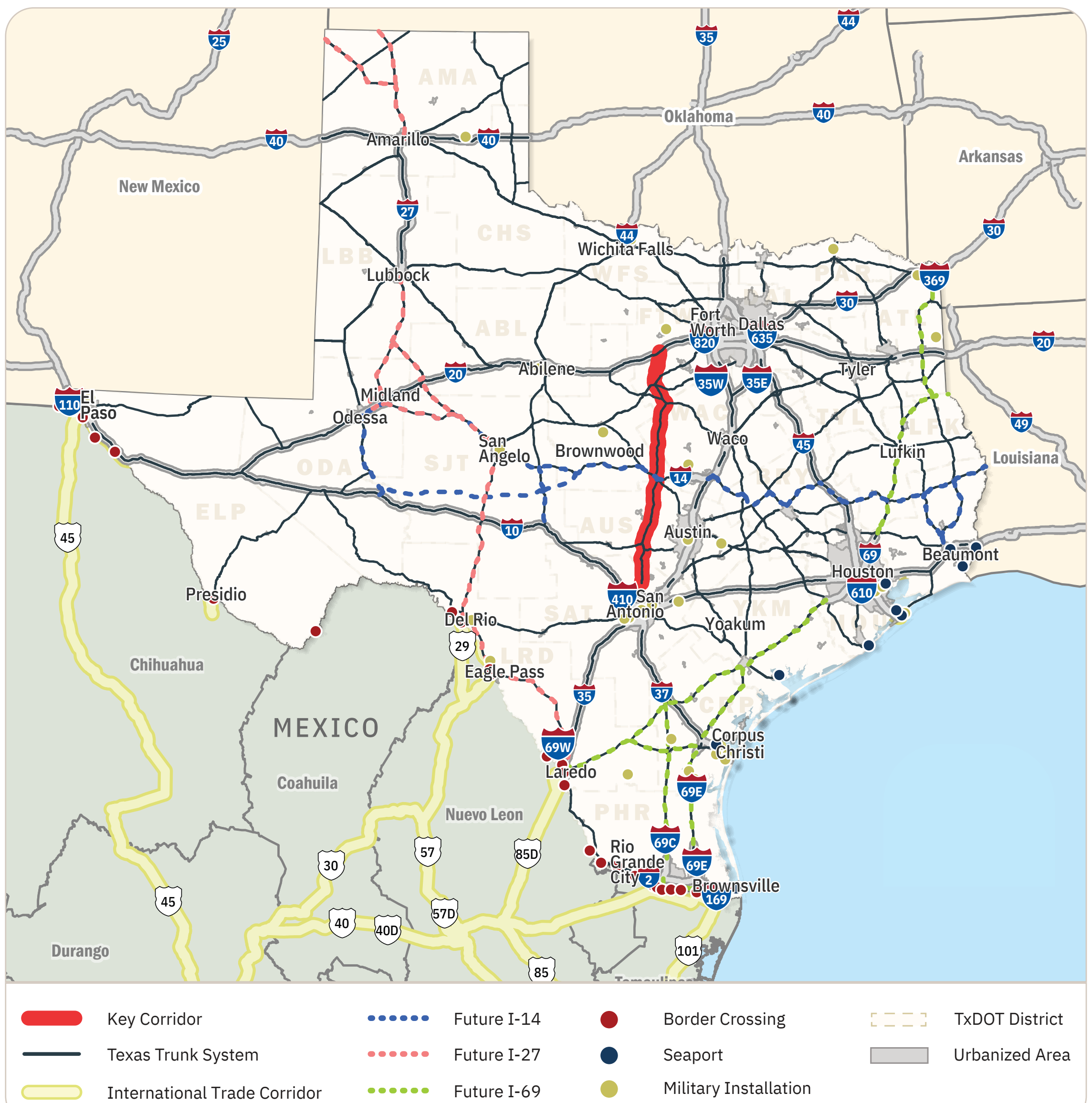
DISTRICTS: AUSTIN, BROWNWOOD, FORT WORTH, SAN ANTONIO, WACO

REVISED: MAY 9, 2025

The Texas Department of Transportation's (TxDOT's) Statewide Rural Connectivity Initiative is focused on systematically upgrading rural corridors on the Texas Highway Trunk System (TTS) to four-lane divided or better highways.

The TTS provides safe, reliable, high-speed travel between economic activity centers – e.g., major cities, oil and gas production areas, deep-draft sea ports, land ports of entry, and agricultural areas - in Texas while supporting the economic health of communities along the corridors. These communities along rural connectivity corridors are defined as small and medium size cities outside urbanized areas that benefit from improved access to markets throughout the state.

The Statewide and Rural Connectivity Task Force guides and provides strategic direction on the prioritization of Key Corridors on the TTS for upgrade to four lane divided or better highways.



US 281 from San Antonio to I-20 is one of the key corridors identified by the Statewide and Rural Connectivity Program for improvement to a four-lane divided corridor. This key corridor connects north and central Texas communities and cities, addresses anticipated congestion and high growth along the corridor, is a potential truck diversion route for I-35, and shares designation with the National Highway System (NHS) and the energy sector.

Key Corridor Supports Texas' Economic Prosperity and Communities

Socio-economic Demographics

5.9 M people **2.6 M jobs**

Source: 2023, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, U.S. Census Bureau
Includes county that the corridor traverse plus adjacent county

Support Military Sector's Contribution to Texas GDP*

$59.3 B

Source: Texas Comptroller of Public Accounts (2023 GDP in current dollars)
Includes military establishments.

Annual Average Daily Traffic

2K - 47K

Source: 2023 TxDOT Roadway Inventory Annual Data

Support Wholesale & Retail Trade Sector's Contribution to Texas GDP*

$54.2 B

Source: U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis (2022 GDP in current dollars)
Includes establishments engaged in wholesaling and retailing merchandise, generally without transformation and rendering services incidental to the sale of merchandise.

Annual Average Daily Truck Traffic

200 - 4K (~11% of all traffic)

Source: 2023 TxDOT Roadway Inventory Annual Data

Support Manufacturing Sector's Contribution to Texas GDP*

$33.1 B

Source: U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis (2022 GDP in current dollars)
Includes establishments engaged in the mechanical, physical, or chemical transformation of materials, substances, or components into new products.

* Includes county that the corridor traverse plus adjacent county

Key Corridor Characteristics

The Texas Highway Trunk System (TTS) is a network of rural highways that aims to improve rural mobility, connect major activity centers (i.e., connections to communities over 20,000 population and connections to commerce), and provide access to ports of entry into Texas. The goal is to upgrade these highways to 4-lane or better divided highways.

Summary of Corridor Progress

Total Corridor Length	To TTS Standards	Not to TTS Standards		
	4+ Lane Divided	2 Lanes	4 Lanes Undivided	Total
204 mi	55 mi (27%)	120 mi	29 mi	149 mi

Based on the 2023 TxDOT Roadway Inventory as well as an aerial satellite image review that used 2024 imagery from TxGIO

Safety Along Corridor

In 2023, statewide rural crashes occur 1.8 times as often on undivided highways than on divided highways. Rural undivided roadways account for 2 in 3 rural crashes and 3 in 4 rural fatalities.

Between 2019-2023	
Number of Crashes	Number of Fatal Crashes
3,543	56

Source: TxDOT Crash Records Information System (CRIS)

Investments Needed to Address Crash Hotspots

$757.8 M (High-level Estimates)

Source: TxDOT Road Inventory and TxDOT Crash Records Information System (CRIS)
Connecting Texas 2050 Statewide Long-Range Transportation Plan

Crash hotspots are locations where crash rates are equal to or higher than 90 crashes per hundred million VMT.

Corridor Project Summary

Completed (Since 2019)

0 mi

Source: Sitemanager

Under Construction

1.8 mi ($24.7 M)

Source: 2025 UTP, Sitemanager, TxDOTCONNECT

Fully Funded

86.6 mi ($1,415.4 M)

Source: 2025 UTP, TxDOTCONNECT

Partial/ Unfunded

108.3 mi ($416.9 M)

Source: 2025 UTP, TxDOTCONNECT

Project tracking since 2019, following the identification of key corridors.
Project data verified by TxDOT Districts and TPP-UTP. Mileage includes sum of all project lengths. Cost includes sum of Estimated Construction Cost.

DRAFT NOT FOR DISTRIBUTION - All information is preliminary & subject to change.